TEST 03 ***Full Name:*** ..... ***Class:*** .....

***

Mark the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the correct answer to each of the following questions.

1. Garbage _____, the town looked much cleaner and more inviting.
A. collected B. collecting C. had been collecting D. was collected
2. _____, things are going well.
A. Worries aside B. Much to worries C. Worries as well D. Except from worries
3. The cashier can't have given us the change, _____?
A. hasn't she B. can she C. must she D. did she
4. Had it not been for the last-minute donation, the animal shelter _____ down.
A. would close B. had closed C. would have closed D. closed
5. The new policy is intended to _____ a balance between national security and individual privacy.
A. strike B. beat C. hit D. press
6. Progress made today will shape our world for years _____.
A. to come B. coming C. in coming D. that will come
7. She was so absorbed in the novel that she was completely _____ to the noise around her.
A. attentive B. acquainted C. oblivious D. conscious
8. Scarcely _____ the presentation when the fire alarm went off.
A. had the lecturer begun B. the lecturer had begun
C. did the lecturer begin D. the lecturer began
9. The company survived the recession only by cutting its assets to the _____.
A. bat B. prong C. tree D. bone
10. The witness's account was completely at _____ with the evidence collected at the scene.
A. comparison B. agreement C. harmony D. odds
11. I need to _____ up on the latest regulations before attending tomorrow's meeting.
A. brush B. sweep C. polish D. clean
12. Long before the votes were counted, his victory was regarded as a _____ conclusion.
A. foremost B. foregone C. forthcoming D. foreseen
13. Although the defendant was acquitted for lack of evidence, public opinion remained firmly _____ him.
A. beside B. against C. opposite D. contrary
14. Through trial and _____, the researchers eventually developed a reliable method of conducting the experiment.
A. fault B. flaw C. blunder D. error
15. During their first few months abroad, the students could afford only the _____ necessities.
A. mere B. sheer C. scant D. bare
16. After keeping the problem to myself for weeks, I finally got it off my _____ by speaking to the school counsellor.
A. head B. eye C. chest D. hand
17. The school has introduced a new curriculum, but it _____ to be seen whether it will improve students' results.
A. remains B. stays C. lasts D. endures
18. *Mai:* "I hear you've been awarded a full scholarship. Congratulations!" *Lan:* "_____"
A. That's beside the point. B. You can say that again.
C. It's out of the question. D. Thanks. I'm over the moon.

19. *Mark the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the word or phrase **CLOSEST** in meaning to the underlined word or phrase.*
The spokesperson's deliberately **ambiguous** statement failed to clarify the government's position.
A. transparent B. irrelevant C. emphatic D. equivocal
20. *Mark the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the word or phrase **OPPOSITE** in meaning to the underlined word or phrase.*
The emergency programme was suspended after its financial resources had been **depleted**.
A. squandered B. replenished C. reduced D. exhausted

Read the following passage and mark the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the word or phrase that best fits each numbered blank.

For much of the twentieth century, city planners treated nature as something that had to be controlled. Rivers were forced into concrete channels, fallen leaves were immediately removed, and grass was cut as short as possible. Recently, however, a growing number of cities have adopted a different approach known as urban rewilding.

Rather than merely planting decorative flower beds, rewilding aims to restore natural ecological processes and allow native plants and animals to (**21**) _____. At first sight, leaving a patch of grass unmown may appear to be a sign of neglect. In reality, such areas can provide insects with food and shelter, (**22**) _____ supporting birds and bats that feed on them.

Urban rewilding is not beyond controversy. Some residents object (**23**) _____ the apparently untidy appearance of wild areas, while others worry that ponds and dense vegetation may attract pests. (**24**) _____ these concerns are properly addressed, public support tends to grow once people understand the rationale behind the policy.

The benefits can (**25**) _____ from lowering urban temperatures to reducing flood risk. Wild vegetation absorbs rainwater more effectively than concrete surfaces, while mature trees provide shade during increasingly frequent heatwaves. Unlike conventional parks, rewilded areas also require less intensive maintenance once they are (**26**) _____.

Urban rewilding is therefore not a retreat from planning. It is a different kind of planning – one that works (**27**) _____ nature rather than constantly attempting to overcome it.

21.	A. accumulate	B. manufacture	C. negotiate	D. thrive
22.	A. despite	B. thereby	C. whereas	D. otherwise
23.	A. for	B. with	C. to	D. against
24.	A. Provided that	B. Unless	C. Even though	D. As if
25.	A. account	B. derive	C. depend	D. range
26.	A. established	B. imposed	C. arranged	D. vanquished
27.	A. over	B. upon	C. beyond	D. with

Read the following passage and mark the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the correct answer to each question.

THE VALUE OF PRODUCTIVE FAILURE

Students often assume that successful learning means finding the correct answer as quickly as possible. Teachers, too, may feel that they are doing their job well when they explain a procedure clearly enough for students to avoid making mistakes. However, an approach known as "productive failure" challenges this assumption. It suggests that, under certain conditions, attempting and failing to solve a problem before receiving formal instruction can result in deeper learning.

In a productive-failure lesson, students are first given a complex problem for which they have not yet been taught the standard method. Working individually or in groups, they attempt to devise their own solutions. Most of these solutions are incomplete or incorrect. The teacher then presents the accepted method and helps the class compare it with the approaches the students have generated.

At first, this sequence appears **counterintuitive**. Why ask students to struggle when the teacher could simply show them what to do? One explanation is that unsuccessful attempts activate relevant prior knowledge and make learners aware of gaps in their understanding. When learners compare their attempts with a formal method, **they** are more likely to notice why particular features of that method matter. By contrast, students who are shown a solution immediately may be able to imitate it without understanding the principles on which it depends.

Studies have found that students taught through productive failure sometimes perform less well on immediate tests of routine procedures. However, they often outperform directly instructed students when asked to explain concepts or apply them to unfamiliar situations. In other words, the initial struggle may reduce short-term efficiency while improving the ability to transfer knowledge.

Nevertheless, productive failure does not mean leaving learners to struggle indefinitely. The task must be challenging but accessible, and students must possess enough background knowledge to engage with it meaningfully. Timely explanation and guidance are essential after the initial problem-solving stage. A classroom environment in which mistakes are treated as useful information rather than evidence of low ability is equally important.

Critics point out that direct instruction remains highly effective for teaching basic facts and procedures, particularly to complete beginners. Productive failure should therefore not be viewed as a replacement for teaching. Its value lies in changing the sequence of teaching: carefully designed exploration comes first, followed by explicit explanation.

28. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the passage?
A. Students learn best only when direct instruction is delayed indefinitely.
B. Productive failure can promote deeper learning when it is carefully structured.
C. Incorrect answers should receive the same marks as correct answers.
D. Complex problems are generally unsuitable for inexperienced learners.

29. The word "**counterintuitive**" in paragraph 3 is **CLOSEST** in meaning to _____.
A. contrary to what one would normally expect
B. impossible to measure accurately
C. based entirely on personal experience
D. likely to produce immediate success

30. Which of the following is **NOT** true about productive failure?
A. Students attempt a problem before being shown the standard method.
B. The teacher later helps students compare different approaches.
C. Students are expected to struggle until they independently discover the correct method.
D. The approach may improve students' ability to use knowledge in new situations.

31. According to paragraph 3, why can incorrect solutions be useful?
A. They reduce the amount of preparation required from teachers.
B. They make students' work easier to assess.
C. They reveal gaps in understanding and prepare students to compare methods.
D. They eliminate the need for subsequent direct instruction.

32. What can be inferred about the successful use of productive failure?
A. It is equally effective regardless of students' existing knowledge.

B. It always improves students' scores on immediate procedural tests.
C. The greater the students' frustration, the more effective the lesson becomes.
D. It depends on appropriate tasks, prior knowledge and follow-up guidance.

33. The word "**they**" in paragraph 3 refers to _____.
A. teachers B. problems C. formal methods D. learners

34. What is the author's main purpose in writing the passage?
A. To explain the benefits, limitations and conditions of an instructional approach
B. To argue that direct instruction has become completely obsolete
C. To describe the historical development of classroom examinations
D. To criticise teachers who correct their students' mistakes

BEAVERS AS ECOSYSTEM ENGINEERS

Beavers once inhabited rivers and streams across much of Europe and North America. For centuries, however, they were intensively hunted for their fur, meat and scent glands. By the beginning of the twentieth century, they had disappeared from many regions. Legal protection and reintroduction programmes have since enabled beaver populations to recover, leading scientists and land managers to reconsider the role these animals play in shaping landscapes.

Beavers are commonly described as "ecosystem engineers" because they physically modify their surroundings. By cutting down trees and constructing dams, they **impound** water that would otherwise flow rapidly downstream. The resulting ponds cause water to spread across the surrounding floodplain. Sediment settles, groundwater levels rise and new wetland habitats develop.

These changes can benefit numerous species. Aquatic insects, amphibians and water birds often become more abundant around beaver ponds. Wetlands created by dams can also retain water during dry periods and slow the movement of storm water, potentially reducing the severity of floods farther downstream. In areas vulnerable to wildfire, the damp vegetation around beaver wetlands may even act as a natural firebreak.

Nevertheless, the effects of beavers are not universally positive. Their dams may flood agricultural fields, block drainage systems or damage valuable trees. The relationship between beaver dams and migratory fish such as salmon is particularly complicated. A dam may temporarily delay a fish's journey, but the deeper pools and cooler water it creates can also provide valuable shelter and feeding grounds. The overall effect therefore varies from one river system to another.

Various techniques have been developed to reduce conflicts. Trees can be protected with wire guards, while specially designed pipes known as flow devices can be inserted through dams. These devices allow water to pass through at a controlled level without requiring the entire dam to be destroyed. In some cases, beavers may be relocated, although this is costly and does not guarantee that other animals will not occupy the same area.

Researchers warn against presenting beavers as a simple solution to every environmental problem. **Their influence depends on valley shape, soil permeability, rainfall patterns and existing land use.** A dam that creates a valuable wetland in one location may flood a road or a productive field in another. Successful reintroduction programmes therefore require careful site selection, long-term monitoring and communication with local communities.

Beavers can make an important contribution to restoring damaged ecosystems, but their return involves trade-offs. Rather than asking whether beavers are entirely beneficial or harmful, land managers increasingly ask where their activities can be tolerated and how conflicts can be managed.

35. The word "**impound**" in paragraph 2 is **CLOSEST** in meaning to _____.
A. hold back B. warm up
C. divert permanently D. pollute

36. What is one direct physical effect of a beaver dam?
A. It causes rain to fall more frequently. B. It slows water and spreads it across the floodplain.
C. It removes sediment from riverbeds. D. It lowers the level of groundwater.

37. Which sentence best expresses the essential information in the underlined sentence?
A. Beaver dams have identical effects wherever they are constructed.
B. Rainfall is the only factor determining the effects of beaver activity.
C. Existing land use becomes unimportant when beavers enter an area.
D. The consequences of beaver activity vary according to several local conditions.

38. Why does the author discuss salmon in paragraph 4?
A. To prove that all beaver dams prevent fish from migrating
B. To illustrate that the ecological effects of dams can be complex
C. To explain why salmon are more valuable than other species
D. To show that beavers depend on salmon as their main food source

39. All of the following are mentioned as possible effects of beaver activity **EXCEPT** _____.
A. the creation of wetland habitats B. reduced downstream flood peaks
C. damage to trees and drainage systems D. guaranteed improvements to agricultural land

40. Why are flow devices placed through some beaver dams?
A. To frighten beavers away from the river

B. To allow fish to be caught more easily
C. To regulate the level of water without removing the whole dam
D. To prevent other animals from entering the wetland

41. What can be inferred about successful beaver-reintroduction programmes?
A. They require both suitable environmental conditions and effective conflict management.
B. They are unlikely to require monitoring after the animals have been released.
C. They should be limited to places where no human activity occurs.
D. They are successful only when all existing dams are left untouched.

42. Which of the following best describes the author's view of beavers?
A. They are dangerous animals whose reintroduction should be stopped.
B. They can provide environmental benefits, but their effects require careful management.
C. They offer a complete and inexpensive solution to climate change.
D. They should be allowed to modify every river system without human intervention.

Mark the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the best arrangement of utterances or sentences to make a meaningful exchange or text in each of the following questions

Question 43. *Dear Parents,*
a. Should you have any questions regarding the revised fee structure, please contact the school office for further clarification.
b. The updated tuition rates will take effect from the beginning of the next academic term in January.
c. We understand that this adjustment may require careful consideration, and we appreciate your continued support.
d. Due to rising operational costs and improvements in educational facilities, the school will be implementing a revised tuition policy.
e. We are writing to inform you of an important update concerning the school's tuition fees.
Yours faithfully,
Greenfield International School
A. d – b – e – a – c **B.** e – d – b – a – c **C.** d – e – b – c – a **D.** e – b – a – d – c

Question 44.
a. In the end, I came to see that leaving my comfort zone had been the most valuable part of the experience.
b. These challenges became clear when navigating unfamiliar streets, sampling local dishes and dealing with a different dialect proved more demanding than I had anticipated.
c. Having to handle everything alone, without the support of friends or family, left me feeling slightly uneasy.
d. In retrospect, the journey not only strengthened my independence but also made me more confident in unfamiliar situations.
e. During the summer holiday, I chose to travel alone to a small coastal town, expecting nothing more than a peaceful break.
A. e – b – c – a – d **B.** b – c – e – a – d **C.** b – e – c – d – a **D.** e – c – b – a – d

Question 45.
a. Over the past few years, the organisation has struggled with communication gaps and declining employee morale.
b. To enhance collaboration, the company introduced regular team-building workshops and cross-departmental projects.
c. As a result, overall productivity improved, and employees reported higher levels of job satisfaction.
d. These initiatives encouraged staff members to share ideas more openly and develop stronger professional relationships.
e. Recognising these challenges, senior managers decided to implement a comprehensive strategy to strengthen teamwork across the company.
A. e – b – a – c – d **B.** a – b – e – d – c **C.** e – a – b – c – d **D.** a – e – b – d – c

Read the following passage and mark the letter A, B, C or D on your answer sheet to indicate the option that best fits each of the numbered blanks

While greenwashing has received significant public attention, brownwashing remains less widely recognised. It occurs when companies intentionally minimise or obscure their genuine environmental progress in public communication. (**46**) _____. As a result, firms may appear less environmentally responsible than they actually are.

One reason for this behaviour is the increasing pressure placed on companies to meet ambitious sustainability targets. (**47**) _____. In such situations, organisations may prefer to avoid strong claims altogether rather than draw attention to commitments they may struggle to fulfil. This cautious approach can be particularly common in highly competitive industries.

However, brownwashing can also create unintended consequences, (**48**) _____. When companies fail to communicate their achievements clearly, stakeholders may struggle to identify which firms are genuinely making progress.

Another concern is that inconsistent communication practices make comparison difficult. (**49**) _____, those that communicate more clearly may gain an advantage, regardless of their actual environmental performance.

To address these challenges, experts suggest that improving both transparency and consistency is essential. The key issue is (**50**) _____.

(Adapted from https://news.umich.edu)

Question 46.

A. This may seem counterintuitive, as businesses are generally expected to highlight their achievements
B. This is often driven by companies' desire to improve their image through environmental communication
C. In addition, sustainability reporting has become an important tool for corporate communication
D. For this reason, many firms attempt to expand their environmental campaigns to reach wider audiences

Question 47.

A. In many cases, companies that fail to live up to these expectations may face criticism and reputational damage
B. As a result, companies invest more resources in promoting their environmental achievements to attract support
C. For example, some organisations prioritise internal improvements before sharing their results publicly
D. In addition, sustainability reporting helps firms communicate their long-term strategies more clearly to investors

Question 48.

A. leaving responsible firms less recognised for their real environmental efforts
B. reflecting differences in standards across sectors and reporting systems
C. reinforcing the role of sustainability reporting in corporate communication
D. making sustainability reporting less common in competitive industries

Question 49.

A. Since corporate communication strategies play an important role in shaping public perception
B. When companies adopt different ways of presenting their environmental results in reports
C. Because environmental reports are often used to support broader corporate messaging
D. Although many organisations aim to improve transparency in sustainability communication

Question 50.

A. whether companies are communicating accurately or creating misleading impressions selectively
B. the extent to which environmental policies influence business decisions in competitive markets
C. how companies can strengthen their reputation through clearer environmental communication
D. why sustainability reporting has become increasingly important in modern corporate practices

----- THE END ------